

K9 OPERATIONS AND CASE LAW FOR OFFICERS & HANDLERS

Fourth Amendment Foundations for Detector Dog Operations

For patrol officers who call for K9 · For K9 handlers who deploy

8-HOUR PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT CLASS



TRAFFIC STOPS · RODRIGUEZ



HOMES & CURTILAGE · JARDINES



THE COURTROOM · HARRIS

CLASS AGENDA

- 01 Roles & foundations**
Place · Caballes · Edmond
- 02 Probable cause & reliability**
Florida v. Harris · records · residual odor
- 03 Homes, curtilage & technology**
Jardines · Dunn · Collins · Earl
- 04 Alabama & 11th Circuit**
Braddy · Bain · Campbell
- 05 Traffic-stop duration**
Rodriguez · no added time without RS
- 06 Handler cueing & video defense**
Four Classes of Behavior · body-cam
- 07 Occupant removal**
Mimms · Wilson · Creller (persuasive)
- 08 Practical exercises + close**
Mock stops · street decision questions

WHO SHOULD ATTEND

- Patrol officers who request a K9 on a stop
- K9 handlers who deploy on the roadside or at a residence
- Supervisors who review reports, video, and PC

STREET RULES YOU WILL LEAVE WITH

- Location controls: roadway ≠ interior ≠ curtilage.
- A sniff is not part of the traffic mission. It cannot add time without independent RS.
- PC is the totality around the dog's behavior — not a checklist, not a final-response-only rule.
- Video, training records, and staying in your lane win the courtroom.

Companion text: Behavior Is Evidence
by David Latimer

DATE

TIME

LOCATION

HOST AGENCY



k9school.net

Law reviewed through September 9, 2026